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need him to support the skipper in the closing overs. Spinners Wanindu Hasaranga and Maheesh Theekshana have been the team's highest wicket-takers since 2024 and will be central to its plans in favourable home conditions. Sri Lanka's pace attack remains unsettled, with bowlers rotated between series. Matheesha Pathirana has been expensive since tweaking his action in early 2025, conceding runs at 9.88 across 27 T20s. This could hand Nuwan Thushara the advantage to partner Dushmantha Chameera.

Zimbabwe has played the second-most T20I games, 41, since the last tournament, with the majority held at home. The side did, however, participate in a tri-series involving Sri Lanka in Pakistan and even managed to upset the Lankan Lions in their second encounter. The team will need a near-flawless campaign to have a shot at qualification and will look to its experienced core, including Sikandar Raza (pic, left) and Blessing Muzarabani, to support Brian Bennett, who has had a remarkable 18 months with the bat, scoring 1,369 runs at a strike rate of 147.52.

Ireland, the fourth full member in the group, and Oman are the other two teams. The former has participated in only 11 matches since the 2024 edition and will look to draw on its experience in Asia, playing against South Africa and Bangladesh. Oman qualified for the showpiece event by finishing second in the Asia & EAP Qualifier 2025-26 held on home turf. Anything other than finishing last in the group would exceed expectations for the Associate side.

(Stats as of January 22)

Group B – T20 World Cup record

Team	Matches Played	Won	Lost	Tie	No Result	Titles won
Australia	47	30	17	–	–	1 (2021)
Sri Lanka	54	32	21	1	–	1 (2014)
Zimbabwe	20	8	11	–	–	–
Ireland	28	7	18	–	3	–
Oman	10	2	6	1	1	–